managed most of the income and wealth in corporations with limited liability for them.

The inequality of income and wealth in the world and the inability of a large chunk of people to earn enough to live a life better than what is described as living below the poverty line, at the minimum, and a life of human dignity beyond what is now recognized as multidimensional poverty is the social challenge.

The corporations today control more than 60 per cent of global GDP and wealth. They have also become convenient vehicles for tax evasion or lower taxation liabilities. The corporations also socialize pollution and carbon discharges to save costs for them at the cost of people at large.

This is the core of the governance challenge today.

The ESG issues that exist today are primarily because of the nature of the industrial economy, the heavy mechanization and fuels used, unequal control of value created and concentration of wealth in the hands of a few.

The industrial age is past its prime. It is now the age of digital technology. Digital technologies are making agriculture and factories more efficient with less fuel consumption. Semiconductor chips are the machines of the digital economy. While industrial-era machines built artificial muscles, digital era technologies built data that creates AI. While machines and energy power took care of production of goods in the industrial era, data and AI are increasingly taking over the production and distribution of services in the digital era.

Digital-era technologies and machines consume less energy. Digital-era energy is also increasingly generated by semiconductors that harness the sun’s natural energy. Wind-power generation, green-hydrogen and other technologies are emerging as better substitutes for fossil fuel energy generation. The digital era has enormous potential to reduce fossil fuel energy consumption. Thus, the digital era is much less worrisome from an environmental viewpoint.